RUSSIAN TORTOISE

Testudo horsfieldii · Central Asian dry steppe (Russia, Iran, Afghanistan, Pakistan, China)
Steppe grazer · Greens + weeds · Wild-range diet

3-SECOND CHECK Is the bowl 90% leafy greens + weeds, no fruit, no protein?

THE RULE Dry-steppe herbivore. NO animal protein. Fruit rare.
Central Asian steppe — weeds, dandelions, wild greens, edible flowers.

≈90% BASE Leafy greens + weeds + wild forage

≈10% TREATS Edible flowers and small vegetables

BASE 90%
Dandelion greens
preferred staple

BASE
Collard, mustard
rotated daily

BASE
Mulberry leaves
wild forage

TREAT 10%
Hibiscus, clover
wild flowers

TREAT
Prickly pear pad
desert browse

Plus other plants and prey from their wild range — pesticide-free only.

TABOO NO ANIMAL PROTEIN. No iceberg. No spinach as staple. No bell pepper. Fruit only a few times a year.

HOW WE FEED

- Leafy greens dominate. Fruit is rare and small — berries or melon a few times a year only.
- NEVER feed animal protein. NEVER use commercial pellets as base.
- Baseline before guest hours — do not feed to fullness before guests arrive.
- All items pesticide- and herbicide-free.

MATCH THE BOWL — DON'T INTERPRET.

If unsure: Pause → Ask → Escalate. No substitutions without approval.

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality. Environment shapes design.